

BALANCE OF CONTROL

Greetings, my dearest friends. There is a great, warm current of strength and love gathered here. This current, or blessing, is the result of your efforts, your growth, your struggle in the right direction. Every one of you here is responsible for some of it. Every one of you here has contributed to it -- and of course, also, some of my friends who are not present tonight.

With this lecture, I shall try again to help you a step further to reach the goal. Now, what is the goal? Spiritual literature and religious teachings, century after century, in all cultures and in all places, in one form or another, always speak about the "fall of the angels," or the "fall from grace." What is really meant by this? Mankind usually interprets this in a literal way, as a happening in time and space. In other words, something happened once upon a time in a certain place, and through certain actions the individuals in question were displaced from one spot to another, or sent down to another geographical sphere. This, of course, is a gross misunderstanding, for what is really meant by it, and what seems so hard for man to understand, is that this is no more and no less than a state of mind. To be separated from God is a state of mind, or a state of consciousness. And to return to God, to one's Creator, is, again, a state of consciousness.

On this road of development, once in a while, after a certain stage has been reached, man discovers within himself a certain power and intelligence which feels as though it were a separate being, an individual other than the usual conscious mind, the feeling that he has of himself. It is as though a vaster, different kind of being were dwelling within. It is as though two brains exist. The second, recently discovered, is much wiser and more satisfying in its guidance and in the way it feels and, it makes the person experience himself.

Of course, this is an illusion, for there are no separate entities involved. But at this point man has taken the first step toward his reunification with the Divine. He is no longer completely separated from it, unable to be activated and moved by it. Only, it is an illusion that there are two minds or consciousnesses or separate beings involved. It is all one consciousness, only it is separated or divided. This separation constitutes what in religion is referred to as the "fall of the angels." In psychology, different terminology describes the identical processes, for integration means nothing other than reunification with the divine. Psychology also speaks of the fact that the integrated, healthy person functions from the center of his being.

The separation from this center is a wall of "not knowing," not knowing that this inner center of all wisdom, love, and power exists. Not knowing this, contact with it is not sought; hence more confusion, error, and ignorance arise. The less awareness of this inner center, the greater the separation from it must be.

When parts of this wall begin to crumble because more self-awareness has been gained while other parts of the wall still persist, occasional contact with the inner center gives the appearance as though two minds, two beings, were involved. What comes forth of this inner self, with its literally infinite possibilities for bliss, for good, for limitless expansion, seems to be totally unconnected with and independent of the familiar personality.

This inner center is the divine consciousness. It permeates the entire universe, it comprises all. Hence, the inner center of one human being is one with the inner center of every other human being. All are filled with this living unity that knows no conflict and no limitation. The creative power at work in any life process is all one and the same. The separation of matter and consciousness is illusion. This is the real meaning of what religion refers to as separation from God, or the "fall of the angels." Working oneself back to the state of bliss which results from being in contact and integrated with the inner center is the "goal" -- not only the goal of such a path, but the unconscious goal of every living being.

The power contained in the nucleus of your innermost being is so vast that you cannot conceive of it, my friends. You can only gradually test it and see it at work, and marvel at it -- first, in smaller ways which nevertheless appear almost miraculous. And as you perceive more and stretch your concepts and vision, you will see it work in inconceivably wonderful ways. This tremendous power is so vast that you cannot conceive of "having it," or "being it," or being activated by it if you choose to conceive of it and call it into being. It is as simple as that.

At the moment, most of you are still separated from it, for you do not really believe and conceive of the realization that you have all you need in order to expand, in order to be in harmony, in the dynamic, creative life process in which you give and receive all that you can possibly dream of.

Not being aware of this live-center is directly connected with not being aware of negative causes that you set in motion. These two facets are interconnected. This is why this pathwork must primarily be concerned with uncovering the images, the wrong concepts, the destructive emotions and behavior patterns. To the extent that these are changed, awareness of the divine in you must follow. The same parallel can be observed regarding an apparently separate, foreign consciousness dwelling within. When the first attempts are being made to bring hitherto unconscious destructive facets to the surface, the individual often feels as though an indwelling destructive entity is at work over which he has no control. He first ascribes negative happenings to an outside fate and fears the world and life around him. As he uncovers his unconscious destructiveness, he begins to fear his own unconscious over which he as yet seems to have no control. Here, too, he feels as though two separate entities were involved: his familiar conscious self with its aims and thoughts, and the newly discovered unconscious with entirely opposite, negative aims and thoughts. As he proceeds in this work, he gradually eliminates the separating factors. He begins to own up to, to feel responsible for this indwelling "entity." He connects with it and can identify with it. Hence, he can take responsibility for it, for by then he and it are one. Its workings are no longer separated from his conscious will. Man's ego integrates with a part of himself that has led him into blind alleys. The wiser ego determines the way. The struggle between it and the indwelling destructive element ceases the moment oneness between the latter and the outer ego is recognized.

It is the identical process with the divine center. Man is at first as unaware of it as of the destructive processes which are deliberately activated. As the mind questions and begins to visualize

its possibilities, what was buried comes to the fore. This applies to the destructive as well as to the most constructive and creative elements in man. The first manifestations of both seem disconnected from the self; and only as it is contemplated and known that they are part of the self, can the self own up to and integrate with them. As far as the negative is concerned, it dissolves in the integration process with the conscious ego. As far as the divine is concerned, it more and more activates and moves the conscious ego, until the latter is one with the former.

Take any momentary undesirable situation or mood you seem unable to change. Somewhere there must be a point in you where you have deliberately produced it, for otherwise you could not be in this situation. As long as you ignore the connection between your wanting the result you now suffer from, and your experiencing this result, that long must you be frantic and frightened. On the other hand, you do all in your power not to admit this self-induced process; you prefer to believe it as an unkind fate. You struggle against this admission for very illusory reasons. But once you want to see the connection, you will -- and then you will be free, even while you still are imperfect. In that area, you will no longer feel helpless and controlled by powers you cannot understand. If you ignore that your present predicament was put in motion by you and may still continue to be put in motion by you, you truly defeat yourself. This ignorance must be eliminated, and recognition of this fact established.

The moment you consider this possibility, even as a question, that whatever you experience is a result of some factor, some cause you have set in motion, the moment you say, "I must somehow have produced it, I want to see where and how, I truly want to see where and how I am producing it," and then let go and let the powers produce the answers, you must inevitably come into possession of this knowledge. In that moment, you will experience the first inkling of peace and of a state of fearlessness because you are, within yourself, someone regarding your cause and effect. Now, all this is not new. I have discussed this in different contexts before. The reason I repeat it is not only that it is so badly needed by a number of my friends because the truth is so easily forgotten when it has not become second nature in the process of growing, but also because it must be repeated to outline the parallel between the negative and positive inner processes. The more awareness of both possibilities within exists, the more integration and identification with both is possible, so that the former dissolves and the latter takes over. But neither awareness can exist unless the conscious ego cultivates and contemplates it. As you own up to the negative aspects in you, you will be capable of owning up to the greatest power there is. As you take ownership and responsibility for the destructive in you, you will no longer be ruled by it, and you will be capable of taking ownership and responsibility for the best in creation -- the divine in you. As you are no longer ruled by the destructive because you identify with it and thus establish self-determination, you shall be empowered by the vastest force in the universe and be activated by it to accomplish hitherto undreamed of results. As you see how the destructive elements in you work and on what motivations they are based, they will cease to frighten you, for you will now be able to determine the course. Concomitantly, you will no longer be frightened by the greatest positive power in existence, dwelling within you, and you will use it by building molds for it with your conscious mind. As long as man fears the destructive in him, he must also fear the divine in him. He will cease to fear the destructive only if and when he is willing to face it squarely.

The goal of being integrated with the divine center does not come in one sweep. As you know, these processes are gradual. There may be areas where one is already quite free and has established a direct contact with the center of the inner self, with the most favorable consequences

in inner and outer life experience. Other areas may still be walled in. The separation still exists by dint of lack of awareness, where you may still not be cognizant of where and how you activate the negative processes, and therefore you cannot bring yourself deliberately to activate the positive ones. It is as though this will is blocked and paralyzed. You may be perfectly capable of communing with the inner nucleus and be guided and moved by it in most wonderful ways in all areas where you have gained freedom through awareness, but the unresolved areas seem to incapacitate you from doing the same in regard to solving this problem. Hence, you are equally separated from knowing what destructive elements are at work as you are separated from the power to help you grow out of it. For such situations, this lecture will be helpful.

As you learn to understand the powers and as you learn to understand these laws at work and to use the powers of your inner faculties, of your mind, of your will direction, and as you understand their potency, to that extent will you no longer feel that there is a separation between your conscious intelligence and will, the active outer mind and personality, and that inner, vast divine self, the center of your inner being, which is, at the same time, the center of the universe.

As long as this separation from the center exists, you must be weak and lost. For, your outer separated brain and personality faculties, by themselves, cannot do what can be accomplished solely and exclusively by the inner center. The outer personality levels serve the one purpose of reaching this inner being; in order to know the power of this inner being; to conceive of the power and the beauty and the possibilities of the inner being; and to establish a deliberate contact with this inner center. This is the purpose of the outer self, and also to allow itself to be guided, moved, and filled with what comes forth from the inner self. It will spontaneously manifest after it has been deliberately called into action. The further purpose of the outer personality is to make room and allow this manifestation to take place. By these two functions, it will eventually integrate with the inner nucleus.

When the outer self tries to accomplish that which the inner being alone is capable of doing successfully, you cannot succeed. You must come into confusion and difficulties, into fear and pain. You must struggle in a most frustrating way. In this utter oblivion of the inner Presence, the outer self will try the harder to control what it cannot control. This must cause more tension, anxiety, a sense of failure, and fear of defeat. On the other hand, the exhaustion of this futile struggle with all its senseless outer pressure must induce the personality to give up where it is most necessary for this not to occur. The purposeful activity is an exact reversal of this situation. Where the personality presses, forces, and pushes, letting go and giving up to a superior force (within the self) would be in order. And where the personality gives up in a hopeless, resigned way without formulating the thoughts that can activate the inner nucleus, effort and will are in order. The line of least resistance prevails in the thought processes which indulge in negativity, while the outer will fights, struggles, and presses against or for a desired result that cannot come as long as the inner faculties are left out of commission. This tense and anxious pushing occurs in a very subtle, but nevertheless very real way. It is directed toward the behavior of others who, one feels, have to manifest in a certain way so that the self can accomplish its goal. And it is also directed toward the resisting self which cannot be forced to feel differently as long as the personality ignores that definite "reasons" exist for its resistance.

This imbalance of control will be observed within the personality when this path progresses. As is observed, it can be reversed. You will be acutely conscious of how you give in to the most

destructive thought patterns and emotions; you will see how in this respect you choose the line of least resistance to give in to these destructive thoughts, feelings, and will-direction. Now that they are no longer hazy and only dimly aware, their effect can be evaluated, and you will be able to halt them and choose a constructive pattern of thinking, feeling, and willing in the area of your momentary problem. You will formulate the one constructive wish to reach inside and deliberately activate that vaster divine self that dwells deep within you.

This is not a difficult action. It is, in fact, a much easier action than what you are doing and the struggle you go through. If only you say, "I, with my outer being, cannot solve this problem. But I know that I must be in confusion and untruth because I am driven to think, feel, and act in a way that produces hopelessness, fear, frustration, feelings of doubt. I will now deliberately contact and activate the most constructive center of my innermost being and let it move me into the thoughts that I need to have at this moment; into the realizations I must have this moment; into actions and feelings that are good and productive in this moment." And then, let go, and let be, and let it move you! Let it "think" through you! Let it feel through you! This is all you have to do. In this way, you activate that most potent live-center. From step to step, it will guide you.

The process now described is not a one time and final action. Inadvertently and at the beginning, you may feel that way. That is, you may pull yourself together at a certain time and follow through this advice and indeed experience the most favorable result. But then, you assume this is it, and it suffices for all further steps. Of course, it does not. For, you are still at the beginning of this integration. It does not yet exist by itself. It must be worked for, and that means the same process of activating and formulating, of conceiving the proper thoughts and will, of calling forth this inner center. It must be repeated. Each juncture presents different road blocks which have to be recognized and put out of the way. Each time difficulties appear and negative moods exist, halting the negativity, that seems so easy to give into, is necessary, and contacting the inner being must be fought through. This is not a hard chore; it really is rather an easy one. Each time you do it, another aspect of that separating wall will be removed. More understanding, more life must come so that eventually you will feel this power that moves you to be your power. You will feel a oneness between your outer self and this area you have to call into being by a deliberate thought process. It will no longer seem as though a second consciousness exists in you. Nor will it be as though the results in your outer life have nothing to do with you. You will be connected both with negative causes you have not seen before and with positive powers you never dreamed possible. This will result in filling you with productive thoughts of truth, expansion, and more vision of possibilities. Each situation will offer many possibilities for desirable results, for solutions and for creative growth.

You cannot come out of any difficulty if you entrust the outer mind exclusively. Let the outer mind be filled with the inner being. Then and then only can you find the way out of each specific problem.

The reversal of balance regarding mind control can best be demonstrated with the following example. Each human being needs and wants love. You all want love. When you are separated from this center within yourself, your approach to obtaining love is a reversal of control. When a proper balance of control exists in this respect, man gives of himself freely and fearlessly. At the same time, he lets the loved one free. He does not force, he does not need to possess, he does not need to own, he does not need to exert a tight control and pressure. Therefore he cannot be owned

or controlled. Hence, he need not fear to love and to be loved. He must realize, in this frame of mind, that love is the greatest freedom, that it must come to him if he lets it, and he does not have to fight or push for it. He can let free because he knows he receives what is his. And love is his because he does not block it, he does not fear or resist it. It is a floating continuum that can never be taken away from him as long as he does not take it away from himself. There is no end to it as long as he does not end it. It is utterly safe; there is no danger and no conflict whatever about it. Therefore, to give of himself, to love, and to contribute do not imply a loss of control. He is in the true sense of the word self-determining. In the best sense, the control is his without tightness or fear.

Whereas in distortion, in false control, man is again in an either/or situation. It is not loving and letting free. He either envisages the false version of love or the false version of letting free. To love is martyrdom, self-effacing submission, self-damaging processes at the expense of the "loved one." To be loved, in the distorted version, is to possess and control the "loved one" completely. Hence, the fear must exist that if he loves, it will mean possession, submission, and martyrdom. Therefore, while he yearns for love, the fear of it must also exist, fear of what loving implies, and fear of not being able to be loved. For the individual rightfully doubts his power to own and control to the exclusive extent that he believes it necessary and as a proof of being loved. Fear of being controlled (to love) and fear of not being able to control (being loved) lead to the false version of letting free, which is withdrawal, indifference, noninvolvement, noncommitment, numbness of feelings, separateness, refusal to love. When man is involved in this distortion, he cannot see that love and freedom are one. He must associate love with lack of freedom. Even if intellectually he knows better, emotionally he cannot experience the freedom and letting free of love.

Such a struggle cannot be resolved if it is attempted with the outer mind, intellect, or will. See the problem and activate the inner center by expressing that you want to give of yourself fearlessly, without danger of being controlled. Express your desire to feel and experience the oneness of love and freedom as you grant it to the other and therefore experience it for yourself. Request guidance to get you to this stage by establishing the sense of integrity and self-acceptance necessary. You will discover that the more you love, the more freedom and selfhood result for yourself. If you express this possibility as a formulated thought and then activate the inner powers to help you experience it, you must come out of whatever problem you may find yourself in at the moment.

Your loneliness, your fears and conflicts, they all, in one way or another, come down to this, that you do not do the only purposeful thing to do -- activate the divine nucleus within yourself. It is the only real, relaxed, and productive control. For it is this inner center which can indeed solve all problems if you let it. And you let it only when you call upon it. It is this inner being, right in you, that knows and understands the "knack" of love without danger, of giving love and freedom, and therefore of receiving love and remaining free. Your outer self does not understand this. It cannot produce for you a state of mind it does not truly comprehend. Your inner self can help you. Call upon it.

Your inner nucleus, with all its powers, can solve all your problems, whatever they are. Whatever your misconceptions are, this indwelling consciousness can change them into truthful states of mind. It is always ready to respond, but it must be specifically contacted. It will fill you with new, stimulating, challenging thoughts, outlooks, and ideas; with feelings of truth and beauty; with guidance that is purposeful. It must respond, for this is the law. This is no magic; it is no

inconceivably difficult feat you have to grow into. You can do it right now if you so choose. All real and constructive actions and experiences in life come forth from this inner center, from this innermost self, that nucleus, that divine substance that is with and in you at all times. It cannot respond unless your outer mind, which is separated from this nucleus, deliberately establishes the contact.

The comprehension and the following through of this is the greatest need for all my friends today. No matter how much we have talked about it in this or that fashion, it is still forgotten, overlooked, neglected, not thought of. So easily do you give in to the negative, the destructive. So readily do you entrust yourself to the outer mechanics in which the negative processes sweep you away into a vortex. At one point, the negative chain is deliberately started -- and this you have to find again and again -- but then it gets out of hand until you can no longer seemingly control it. But you can. It is the simple formulation of the right thought and desire. This is the only effort, my friends. It is the effort you constantly need in order to go through life. When you remain separated from the inner nucleus, it exhausts you needlessly. When you do not make that one instant of effort where you deliberately contact the inner power to fill you with what you need at the moment and to activate you when you do not make this effort, you must use a hundred times more effort than would be necessary if you chose the purposeful way. This unnecessary effort produces failure and disappointment. You give in to the line of least resistance in the one area where effort is required. And then you use a hundred times more effort than you would ever need, just to keep from going under the negativity you have produced in the first place and you have chosen to give in to.

When this process is reversed and you make the effort of halting destructive processes and deliberately contacting the powers within, you will be activated by these powers and the wisdom within. This is a spontaneous process that comes quite effortlessly. But the one effort of pulling your thoughts together, of wanting to come out of negativity, and of entrusting the self to the divine power within, that effort must be made. The desire to come out of any negative inner or outer situation must be formulated. This concise wanting must be clearly and strongly formulated. Reach simultaneously for the inner power to lead the way, step by step.

Now, do not tell me that you doubt its existence, my friends. For even if some of you have not as yet sufficiently experienced it, it does not matter. Even if you still have a doubt, you can follow through this process anyway. You can always express a clearly formulated desire for a constructive result. And even while you doubt the existence of greater wisdom and power within yourself, which is immediately accessible, you can honestly test it and allow it to manifest "if it exists." If you merely argue against it instead of trying it, you are not honest in your doubt. You have nothing to lose, for you have amply experienced that relying solely on your outer faculties has gotten you into the undesirable situation you find yourself in. Outer pressure, tension, and forcing currents have not accomplished it. So try it this way now. Entrust yourself to these inner powers which you do not have to pressure or direct after you formulate the thoughts of constructive will. You will see it work.

Now, my friends, here I have given you a key that could be a major threshold if you but use it, if you use control in the way I describe instead of in the way you have been doing. Now, any one of you here or those who are absent may find areas in which you already do what I have just described. And you will see that in those areas your life is most successful. Things go smoothly and effortlessly. And in fact, you no longer even have to make an effort with your outer mind to

formulate constructive desire and to contact the inner being, for unity has already been established. You already have come home. Your consciousness is completely constructive in all of its expressions; the inner and the outer facets of consciousness are united. There is no division. In these areas, you are in harmony; there is no trace of destructiveness in motivation in the remotest recesses of your personality. What religion refers to as "salvation" and what psychology refers to as integration, mental health, and emotional maturity has taken place in these areas.

At the same time, other areas of your personality are still in the dark regions of conflict, error, separation, doubt, ignorance, and destructive aims. And there, you can accelerate the process of development to a great degree if you use the key I give you.

The false control strengthens the wall of separation. Eliminate this wall by contacting deeper and vaster faculties to activate you, even while the wall is still present. Make this, my friends, your main concern at this time. Use it in whatever area you see fit and wherever you feel you have the greatest need at any given moment of each day. The more resourceful you become in formulating the needs and the requirements in which you wish the inner center to guide and inspire, to activate and fill you with truth, constructive outlooks and energies, the more perfect the manifestations will become -- in so many and such different ways that it will truly fill you with security and trust. Trust in yourself and in the life processes as such.

Ask this constructive power, this nucleus of perfection and beauty, of health and wisdom, to give you the right ideas for removing the separating wall. Request it to inspire you with the most effective meditation at any given moment so that even your outer mind, which must make the first step to establish the contact with the inner center, will be filled with the power and wisdom of the latter to do so. Thus it becomes a two-way interaction. The more you cultivate this process, the safer must you feel, and the more will you realize that there is no problem without a solution. Salvation, my friends, lies exclusively in the fact of reuniting outer mind with inner nucleus. This salvation is so near with all its truth and light and relief and happiness that it just never occurs to you. Go into this deep center of yourself -- and the answers will come forth, enlightenment must follow, and crises will inevitably disappear.

An even greater force of love and power is now activated; for, many of you here have not only understood but have gained an insight or a glimpse, a hope and a light. It shows the way in which they are not dependent on any other power which has to be coerced and be submitted to or cajoled. It is an immediately available power inside. It is so secure and so wonderful. Some of you here have glimpsed it and are on the verge of using it where it is most needed. In that way, they are already out of their crisis or their momentary confusion.

Be blessed, all of you. Be in peace. Be in God!

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